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BUSINESS CASE · JUNE 2026 · AERCHAIN × ADANI GROUP

Procurement at the **Speed of Thought**

A bottom-up, channel-by-channel case for unlocking `$0.7B–$1.2B` in identified annual value across the Adani Group's ~`$20B` procurement engine — by orchestrating AI-native sourcing on top of the existing SAP estate.

ANNUAL SPEND	ANNUAL TRANSACTIONS	CATEGORIES	BUSINESSES
~$20–22B	~100K POs	140–180	~24

PREPARED FOR	PREPARED BY	CLASSIFICATION
Adani Group — Group Procurement & CPO Office	Aerchain (Agillos E-Commerce Pvt. Ltd.)	Strictly Confidential

01 Executive Summary

Identified annual value
$0.7–1.2B
addressable, per year, on ~$20B spend

Cycle-time reduction
−40%
complex-category P2P: ~24d → ~14d

Buyer capacity unlock
~2–3×
strategic throughput, no net hiring

Payback
< 12 mo
value dwarfs platform cost ~300–500×

The Adani Group already runs one of India's most digitally mature procurement functions — SAP Ariba and SAP Business Network across ~24 businesses, ~100,000 POs a year, and ~94% first-time-right digital invoicing. The remaining opportunity is not digitisation; it is **orchestration and judgment at scale**. By layering Aerchain's AI-native sourcing suite on top of the existing SAP estate, the Group can compress cycle times, redirect scarce buyer hours from administrative churn to high-leverage negotiation, and capture **$0.71B–$1.26B/yr** of conservatively-modelled, bottom-up category savings — while strengthening compliance, ESG screening, and audit governance.

> **The single message:** Adani has built the rails; Aerchain runs the trains at the speed of thought — converting a mature-but-manual procurement engine into an autonomous one, with `$0.7–1.2B` of identified annual value against a platform cost of ~`$2.1M/yr`.

02 What we heard — Adani today

Credibility first. Adani is **not** a laggard to be fixed — it is a leader to be accelerated. The foundations below are exactly what make an AI-native orchestration layer land quickly and safely.

Digital backbone
SAP Ariba
+ SAP Business Network, ~24 businesses

Transactions / yr
~100K
POs across the group (~102K txns)

Invoicing quality
~94%
first-time-right digital invoicing

Tier-1 suppliers
7,865
~35% MSME / local sourcing

THE ESTATE

ERP landscape	14 → 18 SAP S/4HANA instances
Sourcing / P2P	SAP Ariba + SAP Business Network
Businesses	~24
Employees	35–40K
Categories	140–180

THE MANDATE SIGNALS

Annual spend	$20–22B (~$36–38B revenue)
MSME / local	~35%
ESG	Supplier ESG screening in place
Coal exposure	>60%
Complex-cat P2P	~24-day median cycle

⇄ Mandate mirror — Adani priorities map directly to Aerchain modules

Every stated Adani priority has a one-to-one Aerchain capability. Nothing here requires re-platforming.

ADANI PRIORITY		
Standardise sourcing across 24 businesses without ripping out SAP	→	**Aerchain S2P orchestration layer** Sits on SAP Ariba / S/4HANA — `zero rip-and-replace`, one playbook across BUs
Apply scarce buyer time only where judgment adds value	→	**Autonomous & Guided Sourcing** AI runs tail & tactical events end-to-end — `~60%` of buyer week returned to strategy
Get faster, more defensible savings on coal, fuel & EPC	→	**Strategic Sourcing + Cleansheet / e-Auction** Should-cost + auctions at scale on `$7.0B` strategic spend
Control tail spend & off-contract leakage	→	**Catalog + Self-Service PO + Tail automation** Maverick `~35–45%` → `<10%` via guided buying
Onboard & risk-screen 7,865 suppliers faster	→	**AI Vendor Onboarding & Due Diligence** Onboarding cycle `−50%`; automated risk / ESG at entry
Support the coal-transition & decarbonisation agenda	→	**ESG Screening + Immutable Audit Ledger** ESG scoring at onboarding; `+20%` compliance, full audit trail

03 The opportunity — where the value is

The spend map tells a classic procurement story: **a handful of channels carry the dollars, but the long tail carries the transactions**. Value is unlocked by applying human judgment selectively — and letting AI run the rest.

CHANNEL	% OF SPEND	~$ VALUE	% OF TXNS
Strategic Sourcing (RFx / negotiated) Structured RFx, high value, low volume	35%	~$7.0B	~12%
Tactical Sourcing (guided RFQ) Repeatable mid-value buys	20%	~$4.0B	~18%
Catalog / Self-Service PO Punch-out & requisition-to-PO	20%	~$4.0B	~34%
Non-PO / Services / RC Recurring & services invoices	15%	~$3.0B	~22%
Tail (<$50K, ad-hoc / local) Long-tail, one-off, local buys	10%	~$2.0B	~14%
Total	100%	~$20B	100%

> **The Pareto / long-tail hook:** roughly `20%` of spend generates close to `~80%` of transactions in the tactical-and-tail zone. Today, expensive strategic-buyer hours are consumed processing low-value, high-frequency events. Aerchain reverses this: **procurement effort applied selectively where human judgment creates the most value**, with AI orchestrating the high-volume remainder autonomously.

COAL / LNG / FUEL
45%
of spend — the strategic prize

CAPITAL PROJECTS / EPC
25%
$5–5.5B capital book; speed = value

INDIRECT + SERVICES + TAIL
30%
indirect 18% · services/RC 7% · tail 5%

04 The savings model (bottom-up)

Modelled **channel-by-channel on $20B of spend**, across seven orchestrated Aerchain channels. Percentages are deliberately conservative — comparable conglomerate peers realise **5–8%** at the portfolio level. The sum is the headline value.

CHANNEL	SPEND	SAVINGS %	ANNUAL SAVINGS
Strategic Sourcing Coal / fuel / EPC / heavy equipment	$7.0B	5–8%	$350–560M
Tactical Sourcing Guided RFQ, mid-value repeatable	$4.0B	4–7%	$160–280M
Autonomous Sourcing AI-run events, tail & recurring	$2.0B	3–6%	$60–120M
Catalog Punch-out & contracted buying	$2.0B	2–4%	$40–80M
Self-Service PO Guided requisition-to-PO	$2.0B	1–3%	$20–60M
Non-PO Services & off-catalog spend	$2.0B	3–6%	$60–120M
RC Invoice Recurring / contract invoices	$1.0B	2–4%	$20–40M
Total — identified annual value	$20.0B	~3.6–6.3%	$710M–$1,260M

> **Read it as:** `$0.71B–$1.26B` of identified, addressable annual value — conservative, modelled bottom-up by channel. These savings **compound across years** as contracts renew on improved baselines, catalog coverage widens, and autonomous coverage climbs from Wave 1 to Wave 3.

05 Double-click: the benefits, decomposed

This is the core of the document. Each benefit is decomposed at three altitudes — **(a) Mechanism** (how the AI achieves it), **(b) Resource & time analysis** (where the hours/days go, today vs. after), and **(c) Calculation → $ value & ROI** (baseline → improved → delta → dollars).

1 Hard-dollar category savings

Three marquee channels carry the bulk of the hard-dollar case. Each is a "today vs. with Aerchain" delta driven by a specific AI mechanism.

i Strategic Sourcing — coal, fuel, EPC & heavy equipment

Strategic · `$7.0B` spend · driver: consolidated demand & should-cost

● **TODAY**
Category managers negotiate BU-by-BU on spreadsheets and prior-year price. Demand is fragmented across ~24 businesses; cleansheets, where they exist, are one-off and manual. Auctions are rare on complex categories.
2–3%
TYPICAL REALISED SAVINGS

● **WITH AERCHAIN**
Group demand is consolidated into single sourcing events; AI-generated cleansheet / should-cost models set the negotiation floor; large-scale e-auctions run on qualified vendor pools. Human buyers own strategy and award.
5–8%
→ $350–560M / YR
⚡ Cleansheet + e-Auction at scale

ii Tactical Sourcing — guided RFQ

Tactical · `$4.0B` spend · driver: playbook-driven competition replacing ad-hoc buys

● **TODAY**
Mid-value buys are placed locally — often single-source, often on last price. Buyers lack time to run a proper 3-bid RFQ, so competitive tension is left on the table across thousands of events a year.
~1%
COMPETITION CAPTURED

● **WITH AERCHAIN**
A guided-RFQ playbook auto-drafts the event, invites qualified vendors, and normalises bids — making a competitive 3+ bid the default path, not the exception. Buyers approve, not assemble.
4–7%
→ $160–280M / YR
⚡ Playbook-driven guided RFQ

iii Tail & Non-PO — leakage recovery

Tail + Non-PO · `$4.0B` combined · driver: autonomous events + consolidation + off-contract recovery

● **TODAY**
~80% of transactions, minimal oversight. Off-contract and maverick buying runs ~35–45%; the same item is bought at different prices across BUs; non-PO leakage escapes negotiated rates entirely.
35–45%
MAVERICK / OFF-CONTRACT

● **WITH AERCHAIN**
Autonomous sourcing runs tail events without a buyer; demand is consolidated to contracted vendors; off-contract spend is intercepted and routed to catalog/negotiated rates. Maverick falls below 10%.
3–6%
→ ~$120–240M / YR
⚡ Autonomous events + leakage recovery

> **Marquee subtotal:** `$350–560M` (strategic) + `$160–280M` (tactical) + ~`$120–240M` (tail & non-PO) ≈ `$630M–$1.08B` of the total identified value comes from these three alone.

2 Cycle-time reduction (−40%)

MECHANISM AI compresses the manual, sequential steps of a complex sourcing cycle. RFx documents are generated from templates and prior awards in hours instead of days; incoming offers are OCR-parsed and normalised to a common schema in minutes; each vendor is scored against technical and commercial criteria automatically; and approvals/NFAs are auto-routed rather than chased by email.

RESOURCE & TIME The saved days come out of **buyer and category-manager hours** and out of **approver wait-time**. A complex event that ties up a buyer for parts of ~24 elapsed days now clears in ~14 — freeing both the buyer's active hours and the queue behind them.

CALC → $ Baseline median **~24 days → improved ~14 days = −10 days (−40%)**. On a **$5–5.5B capital-projects book**, faster award means faster mobilisation — each cycle-week saved advances capex deployment and releases working capital tied up in stalled projects.

Where the ten days come from — stage by stage:

STAGE	TODAY	AERCHAIN	DELTA
RFx drafting & scoping AI generation from templates + prior events	5 d	1 d	−4 d
Offer extraction & normalisation OCR + AI parsing to a common schema	3 d	0.5 d	−2.5 d
Technical + commercial evaluation Per-vendor AI scoring vs. criteria	6 d	4 d	−2 d
Clarifications & negotiation AI drafts; buyer decides	5 d	5 d	0 d
Approvals / NFA routing Auto-routing vs. manual chase	5 d	3.5 d	−1.5 d
Complex-category P2P median	~24 d	~14 d	−40%

> **Capex link:** on Adani's `$5–5.5B` capital-projects book, shaving `10 days` off every sourcing cycle pulls mobilisation forward across the portfolio — a direct working-capital and time-to-revenue benefit on top of the price savings.

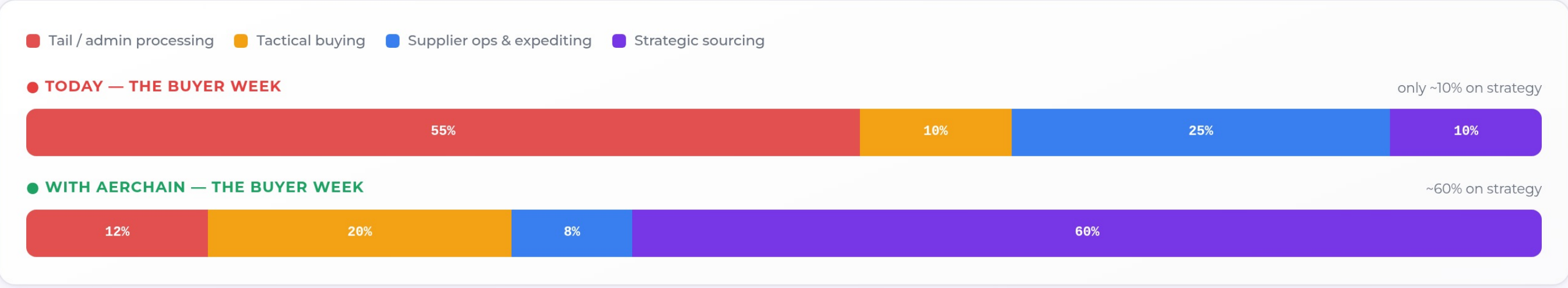
3 Buyer capacity / productivity (+35% → ~2–3× strategic throughput)

MECHANISM Autonomous and guided sourcing absorb the tail and tactical admin that consumes most of a buyer's week. AI drafts RFx, normalises offers, scores vendors, and chases approvals — so the human buyer's hours shift from **assembling** events to **deciding and negotiating** them.

RESOURCE & TIME Reallocating the buyer week: tail/admin **55% → 12%**, supplier ops **25% → 8%**, tactical **10% → 20%**, strategic **10% → 60%**. Strategic time rises ~6× as a share — the practical effect is **~2–3× strategic throughput** per buyer and ~+35% overall productivity.

CALC → $ Group sourcing org ≈ **250 FTEs**. A 2–3× strategic-throughput unlock is equivalent to adding **~150–300 net-new sourcing FTEs** of strategic capacity — **without hiring**. At a fully-loaded ~$60–90K/FTE, that capacity is worth **~$9–27M/yr** in avoided headcount, on top of the savings those buyers now go capture.

The buyer week, reallocated:



> **The arithmetic:** 250 FTEs × (strategic share 10% → 60%) ≈ the strategic capacity of ~`150–300` additional buyers — unlocked without a single net-new hire. Capacity, not cost, becomes the constraint that Aerchain removes.

4 Tail-spend & maverick control

MECHANISM Every requisition is routed through guided buying: if a contract or catalog price exists, the buyer is steered to it; if not, an autonomous event is triggered. Off-contract attempts are intercepted at the point of demand, not discovered in an audit months later.

RESOURCE & TIME This is **demand-side** control — it does not add buyer hours, it removes the need for them. ~20% of spend / ~80% of transactions move from unmanaged to governed with no incremental headcount.

CALC → $ Maverick spend **35–45% → <10%**; leakage recovery of **3–6%** on the ~$4B tail/non-PO base underpins the **~$120–240M** in the savings model. Vendor consolidation across **7,865** tier-1 suppliers compounds the effect.

Before / after — the tail:

TODAY — TAIL OUT OF CONTROL	maverick
Maverick / off-contract	35–45%
Tail transactions	~80% of vol.
Duplicate vendors	7,865 tier-1
Price variance same-SKU	high

Off-contract spend escapes negotiated rates; the same item is bought at many prices across ~24 BUs.

WITH AERCHAIN — TAIL GOVERNED	controlled
Maverick / off-contract	< 10%
Tail run autonomously	majority
Vendor base	consolidated
Leakage recovered	3–6%

Guided buying + autonomous events pull tail onto contracts; consolidation across `7,865` suppliers recovers `3–6%` leakage.

5 Vendor onboarding & due diligence (−50% cycle)

MECHANISM AI-driven onboarding collects and validates supplier documents, auto-runs due-diligence and sanctions/risk checks, and applies ESG screening at the point of entry — replacing weeks of manual back-and-forth.

RESOURCE & TIME Removes onboarding load from category and compliance teams; new suppliers reach first-PO readiness in days rather than weeks, accelerating time-to-value on new sources and MSME inclusion.

CALC → $ Onboarding cycle **−50%** (4–6 wks → 2–3 wks). Faster, safer supplier activation directly supports the **~35% MSME/local** agenda and shortens the path from sourcing decision to delivered value.

Before / after — onboarding:

TODAY — MANUAL ONBOARDING	~4–6 wks
Onboarding cycle	4–6 wks
Diligence	manual, email
Risk / ESG check	ad-hoc
Time-to-first-PO	weeks

Documents chased over email; diligence is inconsistent across BUs; risk surfaces late.

WITH AERCHAIN — AI ONBOARDING	−50%
Onboarding cycle	2–3 wks
Diligence	automated
Risk / ESG check	at entry
Time-to-first-PO	days

AI collects & validates documents, runs automated diligence and ESG screening, and stands the vendor up in half the time.

6 Compliance, governance & ESG

MECHANISM Every event, approval, and award is captured on an immutable audit ledger; policy is enforced in-flow (guided buying, mandatory competition thresholds, approval matrices); ESG criteria are screened at onboarding and re-checked at re-qualification.

RESOURCE & TIME Shifts governance from **after-the-fact audit** to **in-flow enforcement** — compliance and internal-audit teams review exceptions, not the whole population.

CALC → $ Compliance rate **+20%**; a complete, tamper-evident audit trail across ~100K annual transactions. With **>60% of revenue coal-linked**, ESG screening at onboarding directly supports the Group's coal-transition and decarbonisation agenda — measurable supplier-level sustainability data, not attestations.

Compliance rate
+20%
policy enforced in-flow

Audit trail
Immutable
tamper-evident ledger, ~100K txns

ESG screening
At entry
supports coal-transition agenda

Coal exposure
>60%
of revenue — decarbonisation focus

06 The efficiency step-change

The benefits above roll up into a measurable step-change across four operational metrics — and a lift in **net procurement efficiency from ~60–70% to ~80–88%**. Green bars show the improved state; deltas are consistent with every figure used elsewhere in this case.

Cycle time
−40%
24d → 14d

Buyer productivity
+35%
~2–3× strategic throughput

Compliance
+20%
in-flow enforcement

Onboarding speed
+50%
cycle halved

> **Net effect:** procurement efficiency moves from `60–70%` to `80–88%` — a `+15–25%` absolute lift in end-to-end effectiveness across the group.

07 ROI & payback

The investment case is asymmetric to the point of being lopsided. The full S2P platform — SaaS + implementation — is a rounding error against the value it unlocks.

200–350%
3-YEAR ROI
cumulative value vs. platform & implementation cost

350–600%
5-YEAR ROI
savings compound as baselines reset each renewal

< 12 mo
PAYBACK
first-year value clears total investment many times over

THE VALUE-TO-COST RATIO

~$2.1M/yr
Full S2P platform (SaaS) + implementation

$0.7–1.2B/yr
Identified addressable annual value

~300–500×
Value dwarfs cost by this multiple

Bottom line — identified value vs. platform cost **$0.7–1.2B vs. $2.1M**

> **How small the fee is:** the platform costs roughly `0.2–0.3%` of the annual value at stake. Even if the model delivered only a *tenth* of its identified value, ROI would remain in the multiples. This is not a cost decision — it is a capacity-to-capture decision.

08 Roadmap to value

A **16-week** path to first value, then a wave-based rollout that scales coverage from the easy tail to the strategic core.

⏳ 16-week implementation

PHASE 1 · WK 1–4
Discovery & Design
Spend & process baseline across BUs; category prioritisation; playbook design; SAP integration blueprint.

PHASE 2 · WK 5–10
Build & Configure
Configure S2P on SAP estate; catalog & guided-buying rules; approval matrices; ESG & audit ledger.

PHASE 3 · WK 11–13
Pilot — 2 categories
Live pilot on 2 categories; validate savings & cycle-time; refine autonomous thresholds.

PHASE 4 · WK 14–16
Rollout & Hypercare
Scale to Wave-1 categories; hypercare support; adoption tracking; savings realisation reporting.

🌊 Wave-based category rollout

Start where autonomy is easiest and adoption is fastest; expand toward the highest-value, highest-complexity categories.

WAVE 1 — TAIL
<$50K, ad-hoc & local buys. Fastest to autonomous.
`~40% of transactions`

WAVE 2 — INDIRECT
Catalog, MRO, services, mid-value tactical.
`~70% of transactions`

WAVE 3 — DIRECT & STRATEGIC
Coal, fuel, EPC, heavy equipment — the hard-dollar prize.
`100% of transactions`

09 Why Aerchain — not Ariba / Coupa / GEP

The incumbents digitised procurement. Aerchain **automates the judgment** on top of it — and does so without asking Adani to unwind its SAP investment.

🧠 **AI-native, not bolted-on**
Aerchain was built AI-first — autonomous sourcing, cleansheet, and offer normalisation are **core**, not add-on modules retrofitted onto a legacy P2P suite.

🧩 **Full suite + autonomous depth**
One platform spans strategic, tactical, autonomous, catalog, self-service PO, non-PO and RC invoice — with genuine **autonomous-sourcing depth**, not just workflow.

🔗 **SAP-native, sits on your estate**
Runs **on top of** SAP Ariba, Business Network and S/4HANA. **Zero rip-and-replace** — Adani's 14→18-instance estate stays.

🏢 **Proven at conglomerate scale**
Deployed group-wide at **Reliance**, and at **AB InBev** and **Unilever** — complexity and scale comparable to the Adani portfolio.

> **The distinction:** Ariba / Coupa / GEP are systems of record. Aerchain is a **system of action** that sits on the record you already have — which is precisely why it lands fast on Adani's existing estate.

10 Next steps

Four timed, low-friction steps — from alignment to a live proof on Adani's own data, to a kicked-off Phase 1 — inside a month.

1. WEEK 1 — **Executive alignment**
   30-minute session with the CPO office to align on scope, priority categories and success metrics.
2. WEEK 2 — **Should-cost challenge**
   We take one real, recently-awarded project and run an AI cleansheet against it — a live, no-obligation proof of savings.
3. WEEK 3 — **Live demo on Adani data**
   End-to-end guided + autonomous sourcing demonstrated on a representative Adani category and vendor set.
4. WEEK 4 — **Phase-1 kickoff**
   Green-light discovery & design; stand up the joint team; lock the 16-week plan.

> **The ask:** let us run a should-cost challenge on one real awarded project. If we cannot show credible, defensible savings on Adani's own data, there is nothing further to discuss. If we can — the case above scales it to `$0.7–1.2B` a year.

AERCHAIN

Strictly Confidential — prepared for the Adani Group. Figures are modelled estimates of identified, addressable annual value and are conservative and directional, not a guarantee.